FLE TRIBE

WEEK 08 · THURSDAY · LESSON GUIDE

Forms with JavaScript

This week: Make pages interactive: change what's on screen and respond to clicks, typing and forms.

Handle the submit

```
const form = document.querySelector('#task-form');

form.addEventListener('submit', (event) => {
  event.preventDefault(); // stop the page reloading
  const title = form.elements.title.value.trim();
  if (!title) return showError('Enter a task.');
  addTask(title);
  form.reset();
});
```

Friendly validation

- Check on submit first; then re-check as the user fixes the field.
- Put the message right under the field and say how to fix it.
- Keep what they typed: never clear the form when there's an error.
- Link the message to the field with `aria-describedby` so screen readers read it.

Use HTML validation too

`required`, `type="email"` and `minlength` give you free checks. JavaScript adds friendlier messages and rules HTML can't express.

Research questions

Answer these in the app, in your own words, to unlock the next lesson.

1. Validate an email field and show a message under it.
2. When should validation happen: on typing, on leaving a field, or on submit?

Start your research here

- MDN: https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Learn_web_development/Extensions/Forms/Form_validation
- javascript.info: https://javascript.info/forms-submit